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When you think of Amsterdam, most people think of the Red Light District. Well, I caught up with one of the locals in the district, Zad, who runs the fantastic motorcycle-themed bar, the Excalibur, and a major tattoo festival in the Netherlands. Travel Radio Australia, and this month we're in the Red Light District of Amsterdam, and I have one of the locals here who knows all about it.

It's Zad from the Excalibur Bar, which is located right in the centre. Zad, welcome to the program. Hello, hello.

Here's Zad from Amsterdam. Correct. Now, Zad, you've been here for quite a few years at the Excalibur Bar.

You're a bit of a fixture, you know, in the Red Light District, and a lot of people think of it as just as the girls in windows and things like that, but there's lots of bars and restaurants and great places to visit other than that too. That's completely right. You can find your shows here.

Not only sex, also like, you know, regular cool bars, good restaurants, you know, like you can go take a little boat tour for the canals. There's also many people visiting the Red Light District, celebrities from all kinds of industries, movie industry, music industry, rock and roll. Also, the adult industry is coming over, but you can almost do anything you want.

There's so many festivals and parties, and now at this moment there's a Formula One. Everybody comes to Amsterdam City. Yeah, and it's a lovely place, and I've been here on and off for 20 years, and it's really a village, isn't it? Everybody knows each other here who works here, and they all look out for each other too.

That's correct. I think I'm one of the older ones still around. Some people just pass away, some people just retire, and then there's a new generation.

But we all go hand in hand and try to make it all work together. Sometimes we drink up the work, we say hello between coffee and beer, and yeah, sure, we're one big family. Now, the Excalibur Bar is so iconic.

People come here from all over the world. You get famous movie actors and people like that here. Tell us about the Excalibur Bar.

Well, I got this one guy back in 1994. His name is Mr. Hugh. We know him as Quentin Tarantino.

And he came here when he just released the movie Pulp Fiction, one of his famous works. Years later, I had this good friend of him, Michael Metzen, and he came to the bar. Yeah, Michael Metzen's beating what, Kill Bill, Pulp Fiction, he's beating everything.

And I told him about it, and we had a couple of shots of vodka. Then he told me, yeah, Tarantino

sent me all these postcards for Amsterdam. I think, oh, I can remember.

I hand them over a ballpoint to ride them on the bar top right here in Excalibur. And, yeah, of course, then you have all the other famous guys, like Lemmy Kilmister from Motorhead, and you name it, man. All the rock and roll bands.

A bunch of roadies. Even Dropkick Mervis party with me. I party with them on the festival Pink Pop the next day.

It's a pretty cool day, yeah. Now, just describing the bar here, you've got vintage motorcycles on the wall, and they're real motorcycles. Tell us about those.

I got an old Indian from the late 30s. It's a Scout, I think. And it's, yeah, it's very beautiful and very valuable.

And we got a nice little chopper in the front when you come in. In the middle of the bar top, you have a V-Twin Harley-Davidson engine just for the show. Actually, on the other side is the ATM machine.

Pay your bill. No, yeah, it's, yeah, the bar looks great. You've got all the special paint all over the walls and ceilings.

Yeah, I think you should come over to the city center Amsterdam. And the people can get some free stickers from you, too. Yeah, we know.

Occasionally, when the girls warm up a little bit too much, we got them taking the tops off, and sometimes we're without a drink. And then we actually have to cover their nipples with stickers if we want to post a photo of it on our famous multimedia, social media, I mean. Just otherwise, you know, they don't want to see the nipple and stuff.

Well, exactly. That would be illegal. And you don't want anything like that to happen here in the red light.

No. And tell us about this. You're into tattoos here, and you've got a tattoo shop right next door, and you are putting up together a huge tattoo festival.

The next month, 13, 14 and 15 of September, we have the International Amsterdam Tattoo Convention in the NDSM plan, 85, and I'm some new art. Come over and see me, and I host a show over there, and we have the whole world coming over from Samoa, New Zealand, Australia, Hawaii, you name it. That will be there, present, doing the art.

Culture, sharing the love. Apart from the Excalibur Bar, during your times off here in Amsterdam, what's a couple of your favorite things to do that you would recommend to people, maybe from the outside who wouldn't know? Well, you know, I just go occasionally. Personally, I do.

I get a massage. You get a nice dinner. You can actually jump on the train in 25 minutes.

You're on the beach on a nice day or go to one of our foresters or parks. You don't have to always go to the red light. There's so much to do and see.

Walk it. Take a subway. Rent the bicycle if your legs are strong enough and you know how traffic works.

For the rest, yeah. My days are off and I was busy. Yeah, a lot of people think Amsterdam is just the red light district.

A lot of them don't even get out of the red light district. So the other areas like Leitzer plane, Rembrandt's plane, all that. Well, those are great areas.

I used to work in Leitzer plane, and I started in a bar called Borkma. It's a Geneva brand. It was good learning.

It's all different ballgames. A lot of tourists in that area as well. Great hotels.

The American Hotel. The American Hotel. You name them.

They're all there. All the people in all the world come there. And I would go there, too, because there's a little more bar hopping a different way.

No prostitutes. Well, you find them probably in the bar, but we know. You know what I mean.

But the bars, you have more live music in that area. The Leitzer plane area. The waterhole.

Also, the Berber Street. The cave. They all do live rock, metal, and jazz music.

So that's good for you to know. And a lot of these places are free to walk in, too. Some of them you pay a little bit, and some of them, two euros.

I don't know. It's something a little... Depends if there's a famous band. It's actually famous.

It's not famous. If there's a nice band, probably five bucks. How can people find out more about both the tattoo festival and the Excalibur online? That's a good one.

Yeah, well, I think Excalibur, as you find online, www.excalibur.com. And yeah, at the convention, www.tattooexpo.eu. Oh, nice. All very fancy. Yes, that's great.

Well, Zed, I would highly recommend people coming in to see you here in the red light. You're right opposite the old sailor and the black tiger bar, which is just across the street. So if people are coming to the old sailor, they just cross over the bridge, turn right, and they're here at the Excalibur, which is a great experience.

Right across the banana bar, and don't forget to subscribe to my YouTube channel. You can put a link if you want. Yeah, please tell us about YouTube.

Channel Zero by Zed. Me, Zed. I travel, bartend, and I show the world a little bit.

I'm growing a channel if you want to subscribe. Channel Zero by Zed. God, come.

Thank you. And for all of our Dutch friends overseas, can you say hello to them in Dutch for us and ask them? Do you have any Dutch people with me? Yes. Okay, I leave you free.

If you want to come, come to Excalibur, or you don't have to come, we're going to Mutterlands and you're going to have a heart attack. Yeah. Zed the man.

He's the man here in the red light district. Thanks, Zed. See you later.

Cheers. See you later. Got to go to work now.

Great, great. That's Zed from the Excalibur Bar in Amsterdam. If you are coming to this city, make sure that you put that on your list, and don't forget.

Jeff Harrison live from the red light district in Amsterdam City.